

How to get a blocked USB stack and dead microphone working again on Linux

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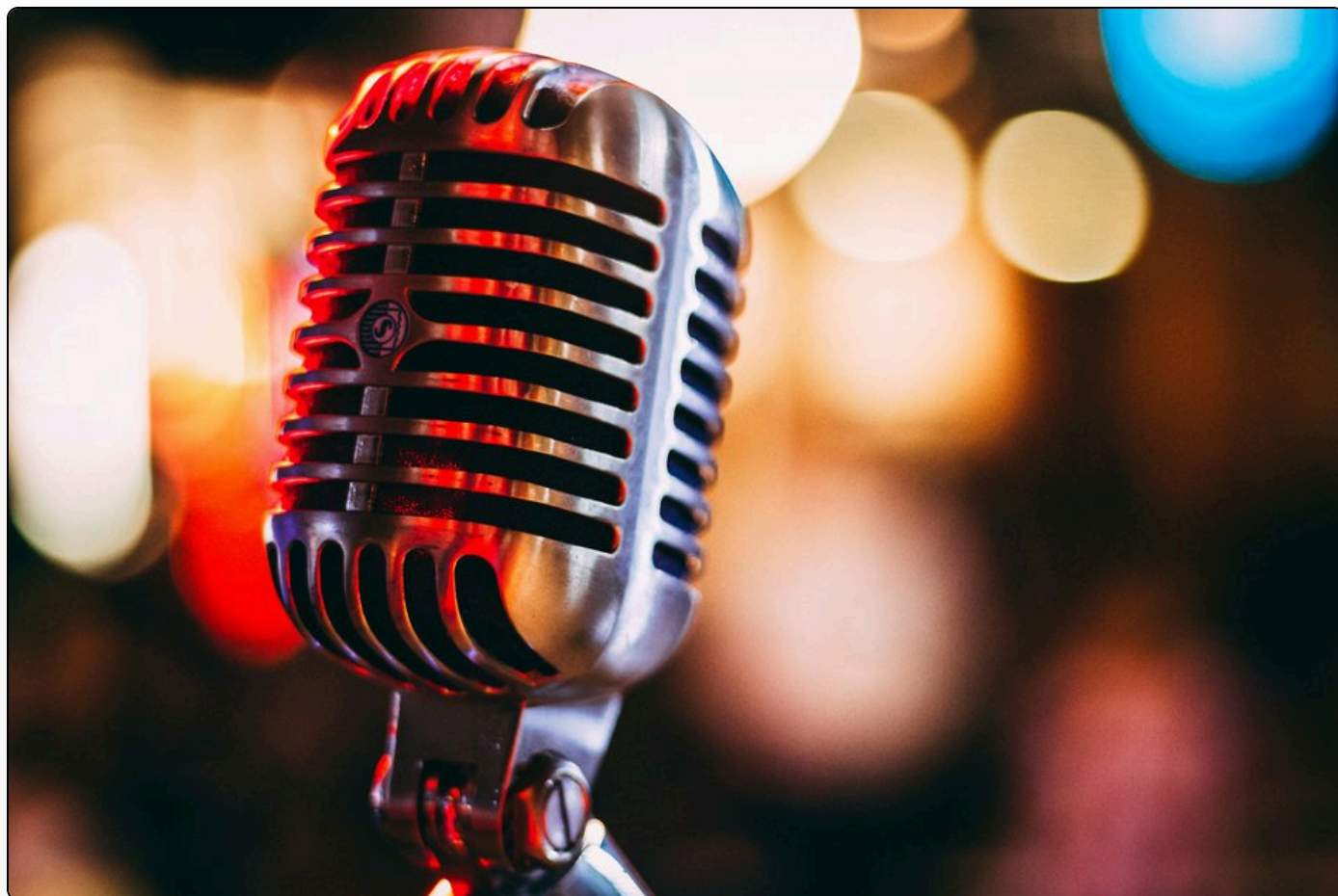


Image: An image of a microphone (israel palacio on unsplash)

I have been having an intermittent problem where my microphone just drops out arbitrarily on Linux and I can't access it anymore. It turns out that this was actually due to a dodgy USB hub inside the motherboard of my computer.

I was finding that looking at `/sys/bus/usb/devices/1-5.1/power/runtime_status` (this will be different on your machine) was showing "error". Oh dear, said Paddington. The symptom was that the device wasn't visible as an audio microphone input. I couldn't use the microphone, and lots of

USB devices were all over the place. For a short while the microphone would appear in the volume control list, but I could not get any signal through it.

The solution in the end was actually quite simple, I just needed to reset the USB “hub”. For me, this is what worked:

```
sudo bash -c 'usbreset 001/003; sleep 2; usbreset 001/002'  
systemctl --user restart wireplumber pipewire pipewire-pulse
```

Not a very exciting post I know, but someone might be helped by it.